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THE TRAFFIC ACT (REGISTRATION PLATES) RULES

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Traffic Act

The Traffic Act (Registration Plates) Rules

Legal Notice 62 of 2016

Legislation as at 31 December 2022

By [Kenya Law](#) and [Laws.Africa](#). Share widely and freely.

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The Traffic Act (Registration Plates) Rules (Legal Notice 62 of 2016)

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TRAFFIC ACT

THE TRAFFIC ACT (REGISTRATION PLATES) RULES

LEGAL NOTICE 62 OF 2016

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Commenced on 22 April 2016

[Amended by [Traffic \(Registration Plates\)\(Amendment\) Rules, 2020 \(Legal Notice 201 of 2020\)](#) on 13 November 2020]
[Amended by [Traffic \(Registration Plates\)\(Amendment\) Rules, 2021 \(Legal Notice 78 of 2021\)](#) on 28 May 2021]
[Revised by [24th Annual Supplement \(Legal Notice 221 of 2023\)](#) on 31 December 2022]

1. Citation

These Rules may be cited as the Traffic (Registration Plates) Rules.

2. Interpretation

In these Rules, unless the context otherwise requires—

"Act" means the Traffic Act (Cap. 403);

"Authority" means the National Transport and Safety Authority established under [section 3](#) of the National Transport and Safety Authority Act (Cap. 404);

"hologram" means a virtual three-dimensional image which changes as the position and orientation of the viewing system changes making the image appear three dimensional and has a minimum measurement of 20 millimetres by 20 millimetres;

"optical recognizable characters" means alpha-numeric Eurofonts with simple, distinct features identifiable using cameras;

"preferred registration numbers" means a desired combination of the numeric characters of the registration plate and includes triple numbers;

"registration plate" means a license plate grade reflective sheeting bonded to aluminium sheet with a minimum thickness of 0.9 millimetres;

"third licence" means a sticker placed on the windscreen of a motor vehicle bearing discrete, overt and covert features of the motor vehicle registration and ownership for technical inspection, tax and insurance validation, highway vignettes, vehicle registration and other compliance and validation requirements; and

"water mark" means a recognizable image or pattern on the registration plate that appears as various shades of lightness or darkness when viewed from different angles.

3. Application

These Rules apply to registration plates carried pursuant to [section 12](#) of the Act and to plates carried for use under a dealer's general licence.

4. Description of a registration plate

- (1) A motor vehicle or trailer shall be fitted with reflective plates and a third licence plate, unless it is being operated under the Authority of a dealer's general licence.

(2) The registration plate shall—

- (a) be rectangular in shape;
- (b) have each letter and number on the plate—
 - (i) consisting of optical recognizable characters;
 - (ii) be at least 75 millimetres high and each part of the letter and number be at least 15 millimetres broad; and
 - (iii) have the total width of the space taken up by each letter be 47.5 mm and the numbers be 44.5 (except in the case of the letter "I" and the number "1"):

Provided that in the case of the plate for a motor cycle, the letters shall be at least 49 millimetres high, every part of every letter and number shall be at least 15 millimetres broad and the total width of the space taken up by every letter shall be 31 millimetres while the space between the numbers shall be 29 millimetres (except in the case of the letter "I");

- (c) except for diplomatic vehicles, bear a national flag with the security hologram at the left hand side and optical recognizable characters;
- (d) have a borderline of 4 millimetres in thickness and a water mark;
- (e) have a unique plate registration serial number at least 25 millimetres;
- (f) have the space between adjoining letter and adjoining numbers of 8 millimetres;
- (g) have a margin between the nearest part of any letter or number and the top margin of 12 millimetres and bottom of 12.5 millimetres, and between the nearest part of any letter or number and the sides of the plate of at least 12 millimetres in the case of motor cycles and at least 25 millimetres in the case of all other vehicles; and
- (h) have the space between the last letter and the first number, or vice versa as the case may be, of 42.5 millimetres, and where the letters and numbers are in separate lines the space between the upper and lower lines shall be of 18.5 millimetres.

5. Restriction on use of registration plates

A person shall not—

- (a) manufacture or sell a reflective registration plate or third licences without the written consent of the Authority;
- (b) alter, modify, cut or otherwise interfere with a registration plate or a third licence issued by the Authority;
- (c) drive a motor vehicle or trailer which has the registration plates or third licence—
 - (i) that is not clearly visible or legible;
 - (ii) that contains a letter or number other than the registration marks assigned to the vehicle or trailer;
 - (iii) that contains a letter or number other than the registration marks authorized by the Authority; or
 - (iv) that does not comply with the provisions of these Rules.

6. General registration plates

- (1) A motor vehicle, other than a motor cycle or trailer, shall have—
 - (a) a general registration plate on the front elevation and another on the back elevation fixed thereon in a horizontal position at right angles to the longitudinal axis of the vehicle; and
 - (b) a third license fixed in a conspicuous and reasonably vertical position behind the glass of the windscreen or nearside window so that the front of the license is clearly visible at all times by daylight to a person standing in front of the vehicle or to the left side thereof.
- (2) A general registration plate for motor vehicle shall—
 - (a) bear seven optical recognizable characters embossed and printed in black on white aluminium reflective sheet;
 - (b) have the front plate measuring 112 millimetres by 520 millimetres with an alternate front plate measuring 205 millimetres by 250 millimetres; and
 - (c) have the rear plate measuring 205 millimetres by 250 millimetres with an alternate rear plate measuring 112 millimetres by 520 millimetres.
- (3) A motor vehicle used under the authority of a dealer's general licence shall have the ground of each dealer's general registration plate in white and the distinctive letters and numbers thereon shall be red.

7. Motorcycle registration plates

- (1) A motor cycle shall have fixed thereon one registration plate at the rear in a horizontal position at right angles to the longitudinal axis of the motorcycle.
- (2) The registration plate of a motor cycle shall—
 - (a) bear seven optical recognizable characters with prefix "KM" embossed and printed in black on yellow aluminium reflective sheet; and
 - (b) measure 155 millimetres by 205 millimetres.

8. Trailer registration plates

- (1) A trailer shall have fixed thereon one plate at the back in a horizontal position at right angles to its longitudinal axis.
- (2) The registration plate of a trailer shall—
 - (a) bear six optical recognizable characters with prefix "Z" embossed and printed in black on yellow aluminium reflective sheet; and
 - (b) have the rear plate measuring 250 millimetres by 205 millimetres with an alternate rear plate measuring 520 millimetres by 112 millimetres.

9. Tractor registration plates

The registration plate of a tractor shall—

- (a) bear eight optical recognizable characters with prefix "KTC" embossed and printed in black on white aluminium reflective sheet;
- (b) have the front plate measuring 520 millimetres by 112 millimetres with an alternate front plate measuring 250 millimetres by 205 millimetres; and

- (c) have the rear plate measuring 250 millimetres by 205 millimetres with an alternate rear plate measuring 520 millimetres by 112 millimetres.

10. Heavy machinery registration plates

The registration plate of a heavy machinery vehicle shall—

- (a) bear eight optical recognizable characters with prefix "KHM" embossed and printed in black on white aluminium reflective sheet;
- (b) have the front plate measuring 520 millimetres by 112 millimetres with an alternate front plate measuring 250 millimetres by 205 millimetres; and
- (c) have the rear plate measuring 250 millimetres by 205 millimetres with an alternate rear plate measuring 520 millimetres by 112 millimetres.

11. Three-wheeler motorcycle registration plates

The registration plate of a three-wheeler motorcycle shall—

- (a) bear eight optical recognizable characters with prefix "KTW" embossed and printed in black on white aluminium reflective sheet;
- (b) have the front plate measuring 520 millimetres by 112 millimetres with an alternate front plate measuring 250 millimetres by 205 millimetres; and
- (c) have the rear plate measuring 250mm by 205mm with an alternate rear plate measuring 520 millimetres by 112 millimetres.

12. State corporation registration plates

The registration plate for a state corporation vehicle shall bear the required number of optical recognizable characters depending on the type of motor vehicle embossed and printed in white on blue aluminium reflective sheet.

13. Garage registration plates

A garage registration plate shall—

- (a) bear six optical recognizable characters with prefix "KG" embossed and four numerical characters printed in white on green aluminium reflective sheet;
- (b) measure 500 millimetres by 112 millimetres.

[LN [78 of 2021](#), r. 2.]

13A. Dealer's registration plate

A dealer's registration plate shall—

- (a) bear six optical recognizable characters with prefix "KD" embossed and four numerical characters printed in white on green aluminium reflective sheet;
- (b) measure 500 millimetres by 112 millimetres.

[LN [78 of 2021](#), r. 3.]

13B. Tow truck registration plate

A tow truck registration plate shall—

- (a) bear six optical recognizable characters with prefix "KT" embossed and four numerical characters printed in white on green aluminium reflective sheet;
- (b) measure 500 millimetres by 112 millimetres.

[LN [78 of 2021](#), r. 3.]

13C. Container freight Station registration plate

A container freight station registration plate shall—

- (a) bear six optical recognizable characters with prefix "KC" embossed and four numerical characters printed in white on green aluminium reflective sheet;
- (b) measure 500 millimetres by 112 millimetres.

[LN [78 of 2021](#), r. 3.]

14. Government of Kenya registration plates

The registration plate of a Government of Kenya vehicle shall bear seven optical recognizable characters with prefix "GK" embossed and printed in black on white aluminium reflective sheet for the front plate and yellow reflective sheet for the rear plate.

14A. Kenya Coast Guard Service registration plates

The registration plate of a Kenya Coast Guard Service vehicle shall bear the serial code "00 KCG 00" of optical recognised characters embossed and printed in black on white aluminium reflective sheet for the front plate and yellow aluminium reflective sheet for the rear plate.

[LN [201 of 2020](#), r. 2.]

15. Diplomatic registration plates

The registration plate of a diplomatic mission shall bear ten optical recognizable characters embossed and printed in white on red aluminium reflective with the first three being numerical numbers depicting the specific diplomatic mission followed by the prefix "CD" and the three numerical registration numbers followed by the prefix "AK" where "A" can vary after every 999 units with the "K" remaining constant.

[LN [78 of 2021](#), r. 4.]

16. United Nations registration plates

- (1) A registration plate of a United Nations vehicle shall bear ten optical recognizable characters embossed and printed in white on red aluminium reflective with the first three being numerical numbers depicting the UN mission followed by the prefix "UN" and the three numerical registration numbers followed by the prefix "AK" where "A" can vary after every 999 units with the "K" remaining constant.
- (2) The registration plate of a representational vehicle shall bear the registration serial code "UNON DG".
- (3) The registration plate of a vehicle for the head of United Nations Environmental Programme and the head of the United Nations Human Settlement Programme shall bear the registration serial code "UN 001" and "UN 002" respectively.

- (4) The registration plate of a vehicle for Permanent Missions to United Nations Environmental Programme and United Nations Human Settlement Programme shall bear the registration serial code "000 PR UN 00".

[L.N. [78 of 2021](#), r. 5.]

17. International organizations registration plates

The registration plate of an international organization shall bear even optical recognizable characters embossed and printed in white on red aluminium reflective with the prefix "KX" followed by two numerical numbers specific to a particular international organization followed by either the prefix "A" for vehicles belonging to the international organization or the prefix "B" for vehicles belonging to the staff of the international organization.

[LN [78 of 2021](#), r. 6.]

18. Applications, forms and fees

- (1) An application for new registration plate shall be made to the Authority in Form A set out in the First Schedule and shall be accompanied by the fee specified in the Second Schedule to these Rules.
- (2) An application for preferred registration numbers shall be made to the Authority in Form A set out in the First Schedule and shall be accompanied by the fee prescribed in the Second Schedule.
- (3) An application for replacement of registration plates shall be made to the Authority in Form B set out in the First Schedule and shall be accompanied by the fee prescribed in the Second Schedule.

19. General penalty

A person who contravenes any of the provision of these Rules, for which no specific penalty is provided in the Act, shall be liable on conviction to a fine not exceeding twenty thousand shillings or to imprisonment for a term not exceeding six months or, to both fine and imprisonment.

20.

[Spent]

FIRST SCHEDULE

Form A

(r. 18(1))

APPLICATION FOR REGISTRATION OF MOTOR VEHICLE, MOTOR CYCLE OR TRAILER



National Transport and Safety Authority

P.O Box 3602-00506
Telephone: +254-(020)
2729200
Fax: +254-(020) 2729200
Email: info@ntsa.go.ke
Website: www.ntsa.go.ke

FORM A THE TRAFFIC ACT CAP 403, Section 6 (2) rule 5

APPLICATION FOR THE REGISTRATION OF MOTOR VEHICLE/MOTOR CYCLE OR TRAILER

A. APPLICATION

Full name (Block Capitals).....

ID No.

PIN

Postal Address Box..... Code Town Mobile Telephone No.....

Other Number E mail

B. PARTICULARS OF VEHICLE (Tick or fill boxes where appropriate) DATE:/...../.....

1. Customs Entry Number 20

2.

Motor vehicle	☒	Trailer	☒	motor cycle	☒
---------------	-------------------------------------	---------	-------------------------------------	-------------	-------------------------------------

3. Male 4. Body Type 5. Other Vehicle Description

6. Year of Manufacture 7. Tare weight

8. Manufactures Chassis or frame number

9. Number of axles 10. Value of the vehicle (Ksh.) 11. Principal body color

12 Has the vehicle been previously registered?

Yes	☒	No	☒
-----	-------------------------------------	----	-------------------------------------

If Yes, Country and Registration Mark/number.....

13. Use: (a) Private..... Carrying Capacity (b) Commercial (goods)..... Loading Capacity.....

(c) Commercial (PSV) Carrying Capacity

14. Expected normal location of vehicle: Road Area/Estate..... Town

County

15. Motor Vehicle only:

Petrol	☒	Diesel	☒	Other	☒
--------	-------------------------------------	--------	-------------------------------------	-------	-------------------------------------

(i) Method of propulsion (Tick as appropriate)

(iii) Rating

(ii) Engine identification number

(cubic Centimeters) CC

16. Type of Number Plate

Rear plate (Tick One):- Elongated

Square:-

Front Plate (Tick one):- elongated

Square:-

17. Preferred number plates numbers (eg. 777,786, 110 etc extra charge apply

C. DECLARATION

I declare that the foregoing particulars are true and complete

Signature.....

D. PREFERRED MODE OF DISPATCH OF LOGBOOK*(Tick as appropriate)*

Postage	Tick	Counter Collection	Tick

FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY:**Amount to Pay:** Registration Fee KSh.....Total KSh.....Date.....**Registration Mark
& Number**

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

Registration Book Number

--

FORM B

(1.8 (3))



THE TRAFFIC ACT
(Cap. 403)

APPLICATION FOR REPLACEMENT OF REGISTRATION PLATES

PERSONAL DETAILS (Details of the registered owner of the vehicle as per log book)

Name of Applicant:-

Surname	First Name	Middle Name
---------	------------	-------------

Address:_____ Mobile No:-_____

Email: _____ Permanent residence:-. _____

VEHICLE DETAILS. (Details of vehicle in respect of which the personalized number is being made)

Make of vehicle:- Model:

Year of manufacture:-_____ Chassis Number:-_____

REPLACEMENT OF NUMBER PLATE

Rear Plate (Tick one) :- Elongated



Square:-



Front plate (Tick one) :- Elongated



Square:-



1, being the applicant of the above number plate(s) declare that I am the registered owner of vehicle No.....whose details are contained in log-book No

Signature.....Date.....

DOCUMENTS TO BE PROVIDED ON APPLICATION.

1. Original and Copy of log book.
2. For individuals:- Identification card or passport of applicant. *(should match the name in the log book).*
3. For companies:- Original and copy of certificate of incorporation

DOCUMENTS TO BE PROVIDED ON COLLECTION.

1. Old plates or original police abstract in case of loss.
2. Original identification documents for the registered owner and person authorized to collect plates
3. Letter of authority to collect in case of a company

FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

It is certified that the above particulars are identical to those contained in the registration Book (log book)

No.....issued onin respect of vehicle registration

No.....

Signature.....

Designation.....

Date

SECOND SCHEDULE

(r. 18)

FEES

Description of Fee	Amount of Fee (KSh.)
Fee for an application for or replacement of front and rear motor vehicle registration plates	3,000
Fee for an application for or replacement of third license.	700
Fee for an application for or replacement of a motor cycle or single registration plate	1,500
Fee for an application for a preferred registration number	30,000